

2.2.3 Hinduism

Good and evil

Good and evil

- Concepts of good and evil
- Beliefs about good and evil as different parts of the nature of deity, and as illusory
- Different aspects of the divine, represented through different deities
- Devas and asuras

The problem of evil

- Concepts of natural and moral evil
 - Approaches to why there is evil and suffering in the world
 - Responses to the problem
 - Belief about karma, dharma and samsara
-

Coping with suffering

- Understanding ways of coping with suffering:
 - Charity and care for the disadvantaged
 - Compassion and dana
 - Detachment and renunciation
-

Sources and reasons for moral behaviour

- The scriptures
 - Examples of gods and goddesses and heroes in scripture
 - Dharma (including varnashramadharma), religious leaders, gurus and important figures
 - Conscience
 - Reasons why Hindus try to follow a moral code
 - Samsara and bhakti
-

Religion, reason and revelation

Form and nature of revelation

- Concept of revelation
 - Revelation through mystical and religious experience
 - Revelation of the divine through the world
-

Authority and importance of sacred texts

- Multiplicity of scriptures
 - Authority of scriptures
 - Shruti
 - Smriti
 - Beliefs about the authority of the Vedas, Upanishads and Bhagavad Gita
-

Religion and science

Origins of the world and life

- Scientific theories about the origins of the world and humanity
 - Teachings about the origins of the world and humanity
 - The relationship between scientific and religious understandings of the origins of the world and humanity
 - Creation stories
 - The idea of the universe as cyclical
 - An understanding of Purusha Shukta
-



People and animals	• The place of humanity in relation to animals • Attitudes to animals and their treatment
Environmental issues	• Responses to environmental issues • Ahimsa as it relates to environmental issues • The teachings of M.K. Gandhi and Krishna • Religious teachings relating to environmental issues